iv. **The Virtual Office:** "Virtual Office" implies mobile or remote work environment equipped with telecommunication links and basic office furniture, but without a fixed office space. Office automation has led to the development of virtual office concept. It works just like a physical office but without physical space and facilities. Employees interact with others through portable communication tools such as electronic mail, cellular phone, voice mail system, laptop computer, fax machine, and audio/video conferencing system. Employees armed with these tools can perform their work from any place — their homes, cars, restaurants, airports, customers' offices, and so on.



Fig. 1.7. Virtual Office

vi. **Back Office:** These offices are generally found in operating corporate organisations where tasks dedicated to operating the company are performed. The term comes from the building layout of early organisations here the front office would contain the sales and other costumer-facing staff and the back office would be those manufacturing or developing the products or involved in administration but without being seen by customers. Although the operations of back office are usually not given a lot of consideration, their contribution to the business is significant.



Fig. 1.8. Back Office

1.6 Office Manager:

An office manager is an individual, who is incharge of an office and whose function is to organize and control the activities of the office. He is appointed to head the office. "The office manager is the pivot around which the office function revolves" (Denyer, J.C.).

He extracts the work from the subordinates to achieve organizational goals. It is his responsibility to plan, organize and control the clerical aspects of the organization including the preparation, communication, coordination and storage of data to support production and other important operations of industrial establishments. He monitors the work processes and evaluates their outcome. On the whole he is appointed as an administrative head of office.

Some of the functional names associated with an office manager are Manager,

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